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While this kind of critique looks for **common ground** between cis and trans bodily experience, the representation of trans subjects is a separate issue. As scholarship in media studies have argued, trans studies subjects occupy distinct roles and thus require their own models of analysis. Thomas Billard and Erique Zhang explain that existing queer and feminist rubrics, which operate within (and against) contexts of patriarchy and heteronormativity, do not apply in the same way to the experience of trans subjects. They ask, for example, "Where does the trans man fall in the hierarchy of patriarchal domination? Does he now dominate women by virtue of his transition?" (Billard and Zhang 195). The authors argue that trans media subjects need their own frameworks for representation, one that is based on reading how trans people represent themselves.

But, the major argument of this paper is that the experience of cis subjects might be read under trans studies frameworks, albeit within certain constraints. While cis and trans media representations vastly contrast each other, with trans subjects occupying distinct roles and plots from cis ones, they nonetheless may overlap temporarily. For example, as Cáel M. Keegan points out, the line between cis and trans dissolves where gender norms are experienced as enforced and oppressive. He discusses the film *The Assignment* (2016), where a hitman named Frank is punished by being forceably transitioned into a woman by a rogue surgeon. Keegan argues that Frank evokes a plight of a trans man: "Frank is forced to live and behave as a woman because he has been assigned a female body... [the film] is arguably about the experience of transgender men—a point entirely missed by the press coverage" (Keegan 34). In Keegan's argument, such "bad objects" for trans media representation, which represent trans lives through tropes of suffering and stereotype, eventually lead to "a world in which the distinction between cis and trans ceases to exist altogether, because the systems enforcing binary sex and gender are dismantled" (36).